

2. Traffic Controller Requirements

2.1 Introduction to Traffic Control

Road worksites are particularly hazardous in comparison to normal road operations. Traffic controllers protect road workers and as such, the training, skills and capability of traffic controllers are critical to the effective operation of worksites where they are used. Traffic controllers are used when signs and devices for roadworks are considered insufficient to provide traffic control for safety, public convenience and efficient job control and management. Traffic controllers have an important safety role on a worksite as well as being the front-line representative of their organisation and conducting an important public relations role when interacting with road users.

2.2 Authority and Accreditation

2.2.1 General

It is a mandatory requirement that any person who undertakes on-site traffic control tasks has successfully completed a traffic controller course provided by an accredited training provider.

Traffic controllers must always keep their traffic controller's ticket with them on their person indicating their accreditation details. Traffic controllers are not authorised to undertake any on-site traffic controlling tasks unless they hold a valid accreditation as a traffic controller at the time.

2.2.2 Authority of a traffic controller

Traffic controllers have the authority to:

- control traffic at road worksites where a road closure or partial road closure is necessary
- control traffic at other events where a road closure or partial road closure is necessary
- control traffic in other circumstances where traffic control is required on a roadway
- legally STOP / SLOW traffic where the traffic speed is previously reduced to 60 km/h or less
- report motorists who fail to follow reasonable directions to the supervisor or the Police
- implement signs and devices that are directly related to the traffic controller's operations.

2.2.3 Work health and safety

All traffic controllers must ensure they are familiar with relevant jurisdictional health and safety regulation, which sets out laws about the health and safety requirements affecting some work activities and specified high risk plant.

All traffic controllers share in the responsibility for the health and safety of all workers in the workplace while carrying out work activities or using specified high-risk plant.